Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/sofia-leathers-43341a282 (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Social Media
Communication
Canva

Sofia Leathers

Policy Researcher - Economic Security & Technology - MENA
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Summary

MENA regional specialist with training in Global Studies, Islamic Studies, and Arabic. Strong oral, written, and interpersonal skills. Research interests include diplomacy, migration, and humanitarian action. Experience living in North Africa, East Africa, and Europe.

Experience

Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS)
Economic Security & Technology Intern
April 2026 - Present (3 months)
Washington, DC

- Conducts research, draft summaries, and proofread communications and publications.
- Supports day-to-day operations of the EST team, including scheduling, databases, and internal tracking.
- Assists in drafting the EST newsletter and other communications.
- Drafts and schedules social media content and design visual assets.

Samuel Hall
Research Assistant
January 2025 - December 2025 (1 year)
Nairobi County, Kenya

- Managed and maintained project schedules for 3-month projects, including scheduling and organizing databases
- Conducted secondary research on topics like localization, humanitarian aid, and migration
- Supported fieldwork team by planning fieldwork, transcribing interviews, and storing data safely

Joy Ride Delray LLC Golf Cart Rentals
Operations Manager
June 2023 - July 2024 (1 year 2 months)
Delray Beach, Florida, United States

- Secured partnerships with local businesses (hotels, rental properties)

- Designed and implemented online in-person marketing strategy
- Instructed customers on golf cart safety and care

Columbia University
Middle East Institute Program Coordinator
September 2022 - December 2023 (1 year 4 months)
New York, NY

- Managed Institute's events by corresponding with faculty members and speakers to plan guest lectures - Designed all promotional material, (weekly newsletters, event posters, web pages, blog posts)
- Coordinated an international conference, including travel logistics for 15 speakers

Roots Academy - جذور
Educational Intern
June 2022 - August 2022 (3 months)
Rabat, Rabat-Salé-Kenitra, Morocco

Created, advertised, and delivered a 3-part workshop series on higher education in the U.S.
Led business meetings with media and graphic design companies
Designed educational programming, like a Sufism trip around Morocco, and a Tajweed class

Yallah Al-Quds
English Teacher for Arabic Speakers
May 2020 - June 2022 (2 years 2 months)
Inezgane-Ait Melloul Prefecture, Souss-Massa, Morocco

I taught weekly online English classes for young adult students in Morocco by creating original curriculum, including weekly lesson plans and homework.

Middlebury Schools Abroad
MENA Refugee Support Intern
June 2021 - August 2021 (3 months)
New Britain, Connecticut, United States

- Taught English classes for Yemeni and Sudanese refugee women
- Led a job-search workshop in Arabic for immigrants and refugees in New Britain
- Supported a Moroccan family's immigration by assisting with employment and paperwork

Al Salwa Publishers

Translator, Arabic-English

September 2020 - December 2020 (4 months)

Amman, Jordan

- Translated 10 manuscripts of children’s books from Arabic to English to be published

All Hands and Hearts

Disaster Relief Construction Volunteer

February 2020 - February 2020 (1 month)

Texas, United States

- Supported displaced elderly homeowners by salvaging belongings from destroyed homes
- Sanitized mold from homes, removed and installed drywall, painted walls
- Led wellness activities on volunteer base, such as yoga classes

Education

Columbia University

Master of Arts - MA, Islamic Studies · (September 2022 - December 2024)

Middlebury College

Bachelor's of Arts, Arabic Language and Literature · (September 2018 - May 2022)

Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilisations (AKU-ISMC)

Master of Arts - MA, Islamic Studies · (September 2023 - December 2024)